

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Internal Audit & GRC Executive | Audit Committee Secretary

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Internal Audit Executive with over 20 years of experience, including 15 years across the GCC, built inside operational businesses: a cloud kitchen technology platform, a multi-sector JSC conglomerate spanning F&B, FMCG, retail, and healthcare, and advisory engagements across QSR, real estate, and hospitality.

Held full Chief Audit Executive (CAE) functional accountability at both Kitopi and Al-Faisaliah Group — sole functional reporting line to the Audit Committee Chair, with the Audit Committee Secretary mandate held in tandem, maintaining strict reporting independence to the Board, while partnering closely with executive leadership to drive systemic remediation.

Achieved the IIA's 'Generally Conforms' external quality rating; led internal due diligence on a USD 127M acquisition that surfaced SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure and reshaped deal terms before closing. Modernized the assurance toolkit through continuous controls monitoring and full-population testing, shifting audit coverage beyond statistical sampling.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Veritux Consulting Network

Founder & Principal, Internal Audit & Risk Advisory

Dubai, UAE

Jul 2025 – Present

- GCC Advisory Practice:** Board- and Audit Committee-facing advisory for GCC operators. Key engagements include a fraud risk policy review for a regional QSR, internal audit charter development for a UAE property developer, and a comprehensive governance diagnostic for a GCC F&B group.
- Forensic Audit Engagement:** Led forensic analysis of a KSA real estate developer's project portfolio across two project reviews; identified SAR 4M in procurement irregularities through full-population transaction testing at a depth conventional sampling would not surface.

Kitopi

Dubai, UAE

Cloud Kitchen Technology Platform | GCC Tech Scale-Up

Director of Internal Audit & GRC | Audit Committee Secretary Jun 2022 – May 2025

- Function Leadership:** Built and led the internal audit and GRC function from the ground up, with sole functional reporting line to the Audit Committee Chair; structured the team across operational risk, IT governance, ethics, and special investigations; designed and executed the risk-based annual audit plan, presenting it to the Audit Committee within three months of joining.
- Audit Committee Secretary:** Orchestrated the Audit Committee's governance framework under pre-IPO scrutiny, including in-camera sessions with external auditors; the dual mandate provided the Board with a direct, unimpeded escalation channel for critical findings and disclosure-sensitive matters ahead of IPO milestones.
- Operational Risk Assurance:** Designed the assurance strategy for a rapid-scale environment; directed the in-house build of an anomaly detection and OCR-based invoice review pipeline that achieved full-population coverage through a 340% surge in transaction volume, proactively partnering with the business to reduce fraud incidents by 78%.
- IT Governance & Cybersecurity Assurance:** Designed the ITGC framework for a rapidly scaling cloud platform; directed group-wide cybersecurity assessments and penetration testing that identified critical exposures, leading to the selection of a managed security contractor and a remediation programme that closed all critical findings raised in the assessment cycle.
- IPO Governance Readiness:** Established the ICFR programme from scratch for the pre-IPO roadmap; EY's external readiness attestation confirmed zero

CONTACT

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🌐 [LinkedIn Profile](#)

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🌐 [Veritux Profile](#)

EDUCATION

Degree: B.Com, Karachi Univ (2003)

ACCA qualification: UK Master's degree equivalent (UK ENIC)

EXPERTISE

Governance & Audit:

IIA Standards
COSO ERM & ISO 31000
ICFR / SOX
COBIT
ISO 27001
NIST CSF
Third-Party Risk
Forensic Investigations
Cybersecurity Assurance

GCC Regulatory:

UAE SCA
KSA CMA Corp Governance
ZATCA e-Invoicing & VAT
UAE Corporate Tax
UAE ESR
AML / Beneficial Ownership
Saudi Companies Law

Audit Technology:

ML continuous monitoring
Audit analytics & OCR testing
NAVEX EthicsPoint
ITGC & Cloud Governance
SAP & Oracle
O365 / G-Suite

material weaknesses and zero significant deficiencies.

- **Ethics Programme & Whistleblowing:** Owned the Group's ethics and whistleblowing programme end-to-end: led competitive selection of NAVEX Ethics-Point, designed the case management framework and escalation protocol, and reported case status directly to the Audit Committee; case management, escalation, and remediation were tracked independently through to Board-level reporting.
- **Sensitive Internal Investigations:** Directed multiple complex internal investigations, including a CAPEX governance breach inquiry, with findings reported directly to the Audit Committee; each case managed end-to-end from scoping through evidence handling and remediation tracking to Board-level reporting.
- **Commercial Integrity Monitoring:** Recovered AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralized AED 4.5M in forward exposure through continuous controls monitoring.

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC)

Riyadh, KSA

Diversified Conglomerate: F&B, FMCG, Retail, Healthcare & Pharma

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk | AC Secretary Nov 2016 – May 2022

- **IIA External Quality Assessment:** Achieved the IIA 'Generally Conforms' rating — the IIA's top rating on external quality assessment — confirming full conformance with IIA Standards across methodology, independence, and governance.
- **Board-Level Governance Reporting:** Ran the Audit Committee's governance machinery across the JSC's diversified portfolio — coordinated cross-sector audit reporting, group-level risk consolidation, related-party and supplier-conduct escalations, and revised Board and committee charters; the dual mandate ensured the holding-company Board maintained direct visibility into subsidiary operations.
- **M&A Due Diligence:** Led internal due diligence on a USD 127M acquisition, identifying SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure; findings were used to renegotiate terms before closing.
- **Function Professionalization:** Grew the internal audit team from 3 to 20 professionals, fostering a high-performance culture and upskilling talent in data analytics and forensic methodologies across the Group.
- **Enterprise Risk Management (ERM):** Built a Board-commissioned ERM framework consolidating Group-wide risk exposure against stated risk appetite; underpinned revised Board and committee charters adopted by the holding company's Audit Committee, and informed an insurance strategy overhaul at the F&B subsidiary that reduced premiums by approximately 15%.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple special investigations across the Group's portfolio — including related-party concerns and supplier conduct — with direct Audit Committee reporting throughout; sustained a 95% substantiation rate and 99% action closure rate across the portfolio.
- **Cybersecurity Vendor Governance:** Led the competitive selection and onboarding of AT&T as Group MSSP, consolidating fragmented in-house coverage into managed threat monitoring across all Group entities.
- **Financial Controls (ICFR):** Designed and implemented the ICFR programme for the Group's F&B subsidiary, establishing its first structured financial reporting control environment; the programme passed EY's external audit with no major control deficiencies identified.
- **Fraud Prevention & Detection:** Generated SAR 4.2M in annual recurring savings through continuous monitoring of procurement and supplier payment processes, deployed via a specialist forensic analytics vendor under audit-defined rule logic and exception thresholds.

Certifications:

Disruptive Strategy (Harvard)
ERM (COSO)
IS Auditing (HKUST)
Forensic Accounting (WVU)
Risk Management (NYIF)

EARLIER CAREER

McDonald's Saudi Arabia

Manager, Internal Audit (2014–2016)

KPMG (Qatar)

Internal Audit Manager (2011–2013)

BMA Asset Management

AVP, Internal Audit (2010–2011)

Ernst & Young (Karachi)

Audit Manager (2004–2009)

PUBLICATIONS

- **GRC Report:** The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing
- **Corporate Compliance Insights:** FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances About How Bribery Works...
- **ACCA AB Magazine:** Keeping Risk Registers Relevant
- **GRC Report:** AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability
- **IIA Magazine:** Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags
- **Consultancy ME:** The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy...